

XIAO (SEAN) ZHAN

seanzhan.com ◇ zhanx@mit.edu ◇ [GitHub](#)

EDUCATION

Massachusetts Institute of Technology Ph.D. Student, Electrical Engineering and Computer Science	Sep 2025 - Current
Massachusetts Institute of Technology M.Sc., Electrical Engineering and Computer Science. GPA: 5.0/5.0.	Sep 2023 - May 2025
Brown University B.S. in Applied Mathematics and Computer Science	Sep 2019 - May 2023

PUBLICATIONS

Learned Localized Mesh Refinement <u>Xiao Zhan</u> , Chrystiano Araújo, Kangle Deng, Maneesh Agrawala, Hsueh-Ti Derek Liu, Mina Konaković Luković.	SIGGRAPH Asia 2026
PhysiOpt: Physics-Driven Shape Optimization for 3D Generative Models. <u>Xiao Zhan</u> *, Clément Jambon*, Evan Thompson, Kenney Ng, Mina Konaković Luković.	SIGGRAPH Asia 2025
CharacterMixer: Rig-Aware Interpolation of 3D Characters. <u>Xiao Zhan</u> , Rao Fu, Daniel Ritchie.	Eurographics 2024
ShapeCrafter: A Recursive Text-Conditioned 3D Shape Generation Model. Rao Fu, <u>Xiao Zhan</u> , Yiwen Chen, Daniel Ritchie, Srinath Sridhar.	NeurIPS 2022

EXPERIENCE

Applied Scientist Intern Engine Geometry Team, advised by Zizhou Huang, Hsueh-Ti Derek Liu • Built real-time reduced-order cloth simulation for artist and user created garments.	May 2026 - Aug 2026 Roblox
Research Intern Engine Geometry Team, advised by Hsueh-Ti Derek Liu • Developed a novel technique to perform localized mesh editing with an autoregressive model.	May 2025 - Aug 2025 Roblox
Research Intern Pixar Research, advised by Mark Meyer • Implemented a part-based neural skinning model to predict corrective shapes for character rigging.	May 2022 - Aug 2022 Pixar Animation Studios
Undergraduate Research Assistant Brown Visual Computing, advised by Daniel Ritchie and Srinath Sridhar • Created the first work to enable character interpolation during animation. • Proposed novel neural architectures to support recursive text-to-shape generation.	Jan 2021 - May 2023 Brown University

FELLOWSHIPS

MathWorks Engineering Fellowship	2025-2026
MIT-IBM Watson AI Lab	2024-2025
MIT EECS Graduate Alumni Fellowship	2023-2024

AWARDS

MIT Generative AI Impact Consortium Best Poster – Science and Engineering	2025
Brown CS Undergrad Research Symposium 2nd Place (out of 19 projects)	2023
Brown CS Undergrad Research Symposium Audience Favorite	2022
Brown Undergrad Teaching and Research Award	2021
Hack@Brown 2021 Winner of Contrary Capital Award (1st out of 66 projects)	2021